EOS WEBINAR MODULE 2

Rocks That Build Capacity

Goals Under a American System Filter

Entrepreneurial Operating System (EOS) Rocks as a System
Ownership, Capacity Outcomes & Weekly Focus

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What You Will Leave With

- The distinction that matters: Rocks as a system of focus and accountability — not only a list of goals
- A filter for capacity-linked Rocks versus cost/fill-only Rocks
- The failure-mode rule: a Rock that only wins by expanding permanent short-cycle temporary or visa labor on critical seats is a capacity risk, not a win
- How capacity Rocks hand off to Scorecard metrics and People seat design

Continuing the EOS Series Arc

Rocks turn Vision into weekly execution. Capacity Rocks keep the system from optimizing cost while strength erodes.

1	2	3	4	5
Vision / V/TO	Rocks as a System	Scorecard	Core Processes	People / Workforce

Filter on native Entrepreneurial Operating System (EOS) tools — not a claim that EOS practice is the American System.

Rocks as a System — Not Only Goals

The value is the operating system: few Rocks, clear owners, weekly review, Identify/Discuss/Solve (IDS) when off track.

Goals alone

A wish list on a wall. Easy to write, easy to forget, no forced weekly accountability.

Rocks as a system

Owned, limited in number, reviewed in Level 10 (weekly leadership meeting). Unfinished work is Identify/Discuss/Solve (IDS)'d — not quietly dropped.

Under the filter

At least one Rock builds capacity. No Rock wins only by expanding permanent short-cycle temporary or visa labor on critical seats.

Current Reality

Rocks that read as revenue, fill-rate, or cost cuts — with no capacity outcome attached

Rocks owned by spectators (HR, Finance) who cannot change seat design or process

Level 10 (weekly leadership meeting) that skips red capacity Rocks when the cost line is still green

Quiet dependence on permanent short-cycle temporary or visa labor to hit the number

Diagnostic Questions

Prefer facts over aspirations. Yes / Partially / No is enough.

1. Do we treat Rocks as a system (few, owned, reviewed in Level 10) — or only as an annual wish list?

2. Is at least one Rock explicitly tied to building capacity (pipeline, knowledge, critical seats, elevated process)?

3. Does any Rock assume permanent short-cycle temporary or visa labor coverage as the way to hit the number?

4. When a capacity Rock is red and cost is green, does Level 10 still Identify/Discuss/Solve (IDS) it?

5. Do capacity Rocks point toward a Scorecard metric and seats Module 5 would protect?

Two Competing Rock Models

COST / FILL ROCKS

“Hit the number with flexible labor and lower cost.”

Wins often depend on expanding short-cycle temporary or visa labor on critical seats. Capacity risk stays off the Rock set. Level 10 celebrates green cost.

CAPACITY ROCKS

“Build capability that compounds and makes the operation harder to copy.”

At least one Rock builds pipeline, knowledge, or critical-seat strength. Operator owns it. Red capacity still gets Identify/Discuss/Solve (IDS) when cost is green.

Directing SI in Rocks

The human owns direction, decisions, standards, review, and final release. SI tools extend the work.

Human instruction: “Read the current Rocks list and the last four Level 10 notes from these sources I am supplying. Return a one-page note that names which Rocks build capacity, which only cut cost, and one Rock that needs an operator owner. Do not recommend staffing changes.”

Bot’s bounded task: Collect and draft the one-page note from the named sources only. Stop at the draft. Do not post, do not change any file, do not invent a seat recommendation.

Review criteria: (1) Every claim has a named source. (2) Open items are listed, not solved. (3) No staffing or cost-cutting recommendations are added; relevant source facts remain accurately reported. (4) The note is one page.

Human release decision: Human reads the draft against the four criteria. If all four pass, human marks it ready and releases it. If any fail, human returns it with the failed criterion named. The bot does not self-release.

Name one Rock. Write the four-part split for one use of SI in reviewing its capacity link. Done when the four-part split is written.

What a Capacity-Linked Rock Looks Like

Not slogans — outcomes an operator can drive in a quarter.

Pipeline	Stand up one veterans or internal pathway that produces candidates for a named critical seat family
Knowledge	Document and transfer institutional knowledge for a process that currently resets every rotation
Seats	Reduce short-cycle temporary or visa share on one critical seat family by a defined amount
Elevation	Automate a low-value step and expand higher-skill American roles in design, maintenance, or improvement

Failure Mode — Capacity Risk

REQUIRED STANDARD

A Rock that can only be hit by expanding permanent short-cycle temporary or visa labor design on critical seats is treated as a capacity risk — not a win.

- Green Rock status can hide eroding knowledge and weaker pipelines.
- Spectator ownership means nobody who can change seat design is accountable.
- Strip or reframe the Rock; put the risk on Issues; link a true capacity outcome instead.

Level 10 Discipline Under the Filter

Level 10 is the weekly leadership meeting. Native Level 10 stays. The filter changes what gets Identify/Discuss/Solve (IDS)'d when numbers conflict.

01

Few Rocks

Enough to focus; not so many that capacity work disappears under noise

02

Operator owners

Someone who can change process, seats, or pipeline — not only report status

03

Capacity when cost is green

Red capacity Rocks still get IDS time; green cost is not a free pass

04

Hand-off language

Capacity Rocks name a metric direction (Module 3) and a seat family (Module 5)

Three Highest-Leverage Moves

1

Tag the set

List current Rocks. Mark capacity-linked vs cost/fill only. Flag any that depend on permanent short-cycle temporary or visa labor design.

2

Add or rewrite one

One capacity Rock with an operator owner and a due date — pipeline, knowledge, critical seat, or elevated process.

3

Protect it in Level 10

When that Rock is red and cost is green, Identify/Discuss/Solve (IDS) it anyway. Link metric and seat placeholders for Modules 3 and 5.

From Rocks Into the System

Vision/Traction Organizer (V/TO) → Rocks → Scorecard → Core Processes → People

Capacity Rocks make Scorecard and People work real instead of decorative.

Operating in the United States is not workforce-neutral.
Seat design either builds lasting productive capacity or rents weakness.

Next: free companion (diagnostic + 90-day outline) · Module 3 Scorecard · paid 90-Day Sprint for deeper execution support.

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